colonial-era worthies. King George V glares down from a pedestal removed from the canopy opposite India Gate in the 1960s. There are several pedestals without statues, as if their occupants were upset by years of neglect and have walked off.

The architects Edwin Lutyens and Herbert Baker were given the job of designing the new city. The original idea was to build the city to the north of Shahjehanabad, roughly around where Delhi University now stands. However, after a number of ground surveys, it was decided to build the new city to the south of the existing urban cluster. This had the symbolic advantage of being close to the ruins of many older Delhis—Dinpanah, Indraprastha, Feroze Shah Kotla. Note that the new city was not built as a practical hub of commerce and industry. It was meant as a display of imperial power—a city of magnificent processions and imposing symbolic structures.

The centrepiece was the palace of the Viceroy built on Raisina Hill, what we now know as Rashtrapati Bhavan. There were many opinions about what this building should look like, ranging from classical European to Indo–Sarcenic and Mughal. Lutyens's own opinion of India aesthetics was closer to those of Mughal Emperor Babur, but Baker was somewhat more sympathetic to the native style. Ultimately, the compromise was a design that combines classical European columns with Mughal and Rajput detailing. In front of the palace was a grand avenue called Kingsway (now Rajpath) inspired by the Mall in Washington DC. The intention was to impress and, more than a century later, it still impresses.

The rest of New Delhi consisted of government offices and spacious bungalows built in the mould of a garden city. It was a Civil Lines on a gigantic scale with a strict hierarchy. In the delightful politically incorrect style of the time, the residential areas were clearly demarcated on the basis of race and seniority as 'fat white', 'thin white' and 'thin black'. Since no senior Indian official was envisaged, there was no space for 'fat black'. [24] The whole thing was designed for a population of less than 60,000 including servants and other support staff. The only space for commerce was Connaught Place and its surroundings. Dubbed as 'Lutyens's Delhi',